

Dual Space

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Linear Functional

A linear functional is a linear map from V to F . In other words, a linear functional is an element of $\mathcal{L}(V, F)$

Example 0.1. Define $\phi : \mathbf{R}^3 \rightarrow \mathbf{R}$ by $\phi(x, y, z) = 4x - 5y + 2z$. Then ϕ is a linear functional on $\mathbf{R}^3$

Example 0.2. Fix $(c_1, c_2, \dots, c_n) \in \mathbf{F}^n$. Define $\phi : \mathbf{F}^n \rightarrow \mathbf{F}$ by $\phi(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n) = c_1x_1 + c_2x_2 + \dots + c_nx_n$

Example 0.3. Define $\phi : \mathcal{P}(\mathbf{R}) \rightarrow \mathbf{R}$ by $\phi(p) = 3p''(5) + 7p(4)$. Then ϕ is a linear functional on $\mathcal{P}(\mathbf{R})$

Definition 1. The dual space of V , denoted by V' , is the vector space of all linear functionals on V . In other words, $V' = \mathcal{L}(V, F)$

Theorem 0.4. Suppose V is finite dimensional. Then V' is also finite-dimensional and $\dim V = \dim V'$

Proof. let $V' = \mathcal{L}(V, F)$,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Now, } \dim(V') &= \dim(\mathcal{L}(V, F)) \\ &= \dim(V) \cdot \dim(F) \\ &= \dim(V) \quad \because \dim(F) = 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$\boxed{\dim(V') = \dim(V)}$$

hence, V' is finite dimensional and $\dim(V') = \dim(V)$ □

Definition 2. if $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$ is a basis of V , then the dual basis of $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$ is the list of $\phi_1, \phi_2, \dots, \phi_n$ of elements of V' , where each ϕ_j is the linear functional on V such that

$$\phi_j(v_k) = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } k = j, \\ 0, & \text{if } k \neq j \end{cases}$$

Theorem 0.5. Suppose $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$ is basis of V and $\phi_1, \phi_2, \dots, \phi_n$ is the dual basis. Then

$$v = \phi_1(v)v_1 + \dots + \phi_n(v)v_n$$

for each $v \in V$

Proof. Suppose $v \in V$. Then there exist $c_1, c_2, \dots, c_n \in \mathbf{F}$ such that

$$v = \sum_{i=1}^n c_i \cdot v_i$$

consider, $\phi_j(v) = \phi_j(\sum_{i=1}^n c_i \cdot v_i)$ where $j \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \phi_j(c_1 v_1) + \phi_j(c_2 v_2) + \dots + \phi_j(c_n v_n) \\ &= \phi_j(c_j v_j) \\ &= c_j \phi_j(v_j) \end{aligned}$$

$$\because \phi_j(v_j) = 1$$

$$\phi_j(v) = c_j$$

if $j = i$, then $\phi_j(v) = c_i$,

therefore, $\boxed{v = \sum_{i=1}^n \phi_i(v) v_i}$

□